

IS THE QWERTY DEAD?

Sean Hollister from The Verge thinks the once-vaunted smart-phone keyboard

is the victim of a fickle market. In this article he analyses the fall of the physical keyboard and wonders if any company will go that way ever again.

<http://dgit.in/qwertyph>

SIX SCIENCE MYTHS BUSTED

People have this tendency to occasionally lob whatever untruth comes flying at them right back at somebody else like a game of ping pong. Here are six of those that we've been hearing since our school days. About time to set the record straight.

<http://dgit.in/sixsci>

EXPOSING THE NSA

How much big brother knows has been the subject matter of a lot of debates and articles.

In this fresh look at the subject post the Snowden exposures, we get to dive into the dark world of governmental espionage. This is a long but enlightening read.

<http://dgit.in/saured>

PLAYSTATION 4 REVIEW

It's going to take some time for the PS 4 to hit Indian shores. Until then you should definitely check out Polygon's comprehensive review of the next gen gaming console. The controller is a major leap, the Wi-Fi standard could've been better and right now it's just waiting for better games to appear.

<http://dgit.in/ps4revu>

Google Chromebook: Is it the right laptop for you?

Chrome OS is a completely new operating system and clearly, meant for a very specific user base. Find out if it's made for you.

- By Vishal Mathur

The last couple of months have seen a fair amount of movement on the alternative OS front, for the want of simplicity and ease of use. Google pushed Android on some AIOs recently and HP was leading that march. But, the new Chrome OS is a more refined alternative to Windows and Mac OS X. All laptops that come pre-loaded with Chrome OS are called Chromebooks, irrespective of brand or model. Currently, Acer, Samsung and HP are making some Chromebooks but more laptop makers surely join in in due course of time with a wider range of products.

For anyone who is looking to shift from their current OS, do keep this in mind - it will be a major change, in some regards, with respect to productivity.

Usability, from the GO!

If you had chided Microsoft for the lack of the start button in Windows 8, this OS will possibly invite more snorts of derision. But then again, the purpose and the method of achieving it are completely different. And that is the learning curve with Chrome. Sign into your Google account, and what awaits you is the traditional desktop, with a difference. On the taskbar (called Shelf, in this case) are the icons for Chrome browser, Gmail, Google Search, Google Docs and YouTube. If you use an Android phone, you will immediately recognize an icon very similar to the one that takes you to the app drawer. This is where the "apps" sit - stuff like the



file manager, Tweet Deck or anything else that you may have downloaded.

For starters, and for all purposes, most of the stuff will run in the Chrome web browser. Too much Chrome branding to get confused with, but bear with us! The base is the Chrome OS, while the quintessential window to the world of the Internets is the Chrome browser. You can download apps on the Chromebook, but they will almost always be web based versions. Dropbox? Web version. Pixlr image editor? Web version. Tweet Deck? Web version. Clicking on their icon / shortcut means the Chrome browser will open them with relevant content. What you essentially need to come to terms with is that most of these "apps" that you download from the Chrome store, are shortcuts to the web page. And that, for most users, is a major change.

The file manager / file browser (simply called *Files*) will not run in the web browser. If you miss the folder structure traditional to Windows or Mac, this will bring some

sense of familiarity. Two major tabs here - Google Drive and Downloads. On the top right of the window is the settings option, allowing you change the view, or create a new folder. Fairly basic, and should get most tasks done. However, we could not find a way to create more folders, apart from Drive and Downloads.

Who can switch over to a Chromebook, and who shouldn't

Using it as the primary machine at work for a few days had a steep learning curve. If you are using the Google ecosystem right now - Mail, Docs etc, and not relying too much on third party software installed on the PC, then adopting the Chromebook should be the simplest task in the world. Otherwise the change may not be smooth. Keep in mind that any reliance you may have on Dropbox will also be shifted to Google Drive.

Cannot neglect the sheer advantages

As an OS, Chrome has its distinct advantages. It is simple, uncluttered, and to the point. True, there are no pretensions of taking on Windows or OS X which is what makes this new platform so enticing. Chrome OS is meant very specifically for someone who is already using the Google ecosystem for their work or for someone who needs a simple to use laptop for web browsing, emails, streaming and playing the odd casual game. 